

Category	1-2	3-4	5	Judges Score
Problem and need (20%): Does the pitch clearly identify a real problem or unmet need? Is there evidence that the problem is meaningful to the target users?	1–2: Problem is vague or unclear; no clear evidence of need.	3–4: Problem is clear, but the “why now” or “who needs it” is thin.	5: Problem is specific, well-defined, and clearly felt by the target audience.	
Idea / solution (20%): Is the solution (product, service, experience, platform) clearly explained in 30 seconds or less? Does it actually address the problem in a way that feels logical or innovative?	1–2: Solution is confusing, doesn’t clearly solve the problem.	3–4: Solution is clear and addresses the problem, but feels predictable or unspecified.	5: Solution is simple to grasp and clearly aligned with the problem.	
Target audience and impact (20%): Who is the primary audience, and how is the audience description specific (not “everyone”)? Does the pitch suggest realistic or meaningful impact (user benefits, social, academic, campus-level, etc.)?	1–2: Audience is undefined or generic; no clear impact.	3–4: Audience is named; some idea of impact.	5: Audience is specific; impact is concrete and well-articulated.	
Innovation and originality (20%): Is the idea novel, differentiated, or creatively reframing an existing problem? Does it show courage to think “outside the box” regardless of technical maturity?	1–2: Idea is generic or obviously copied.	3–4: Some uniqueness or twist, but the differentiation isn’t sharp.	5: Idea feels fresh, original, or creatively re-imagined.	
Clarity and communication (20%): Is the pitch easy to follow in 60 seconds? Does it avoid jargon, use simple language, and structure the message (problem → solution → outcome)?	1–2: Disorganized or hard to follow.	3–4: Clear but could be tighter or more concise.	5: Extremely clear, concise, and well-structured.	
Overall Score				/25